6. The spirit of détente was carried forward with the United States and Soviet Union's Apollo–Soyuz joint mission in July 1975.
7. Détente also gave an opportunity to the United States to mend its relationship with China.

Certain Uncertainties and End of Détente

Despite careful nurturing of détente, its spirit did not live long and several irritants cropped up. Czechoslovakia experienced **Prague Spring** or socialism with a human face, under the reformist leader, Alexander Dubèhèk in 1967 who also decided to withdraw from the WARSAW Pact. Brezhnev apprehended that Dubčhèk's reforms had been intended to foment a nationalist counter-revolution within the Soviet sphere of influence and Dubčhek's move signalled its defection towards the West. Soon, Brezhnev proclaimed what came to be known as the **Brezhnev Doctrine** which stipulated in no uncertain terms that a communist state was within its rights when it intervenes in the internal affairs of an East European state if such action would prevent the re-introduction of a capitalist social system. Working along the lines of this doctrine Brezhnev took steps to crush the **Prague Spring.** This became an irritant in the East–West relations.[15]

The Indo–Pak War of 1965–66 and the War of liberation of Bangladesh in 1971 fuelled the superpower rivalry. Then there was the Middle East crisis which also dampened the mood of the détente in 1973. After the six-day-war, Israel occupied the Sharm El-Sheikh, Sinai and drove the Jordanian troops from Jerusalem and savaged the Syrian army in the Golan Heights. The defeat was a great humiliation to the pan-Arab national pride. The Arab nations continued their refusal to recognize Israel resulting in intermittent raids and skirmishes. But matters came to a head again when Anwar Sadat, who succeeded Nasser, with a combined Egyptian–Syrian force, launched a surprise attack on 6 October 1973—the Jewish Day of Atonement (*Yom Kippur*)—against Israel. After the initial shock, the Israelis were capable of stopping the advance of the combined forces. At this stage the Arab nations imposed an oil embargo on any country aiding Israel. The United States was the